

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

It's time to have a meeting with the team!



Learning Outcome

Accurately use important information about people's jobs and places of work in communicative situations.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about jobs and work.
- I can use expressions to manage a meeting.
- I can ask for clarification.

Ask your partner:

- Do you like to have meetings? Why or why not?
- Why is it important to ask for clarification in a meeting?
- Have you been in a situation where you had to ask for clarification? What did you say?





Let's Explore!

Miranda **calls for*** a meeting with her team. What do they discuss?

* To "call for" means to require that something happen.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Miranda:** I'd like to welcome everyone to the meeting. Thank you, Peter, and the rest of the staff for making it on such short notice.
- Miranda:** Let's get down to business, shall we?
- Miranda:** Has everyone got a copy of the agenda?
- Peter:** Sorry, I am not sure I am following you.
- Miranda:** Did you read the agenda and supporting documentation in advance?
- Pete** r: Oh yes ... yes, I have.
- Miranda:** Okay then. The first thing on the agenda is our new potential client – Holly's. Farmani – CEO of Holly's - is currently on the lookout for a new PR Agency. I have told him during our meeting that Polygon has expressed an interest in the deal and will be formalizing a proposal.
- Peter:** Excuse me. Could you elaborate on that?
- Miranda:** Basically, we have to submit a proposal with our visions and ideas for their image management and publicity. Do you have any ideas, Peter?
- Peter:** I'm sorry, could you be more specific?
- Miranda:** Of course! Our firm needs to manage the company's communication through social media – as well as traditional advertising by staging or sponsoring events to promote their new clothing line. I think that this pretty much brings us to the end of our meeting. Thank you all for your contribution and for attending today.



Let's Practice!

Peter is in a meeting but he wants some clarification. What does he say?

Instructions: Circle all the correct answers.

- Which statements could Peter use to express a lack of understanding?
 - Yes, I have.
 - Sorry, I'm not sure I am following you.
 - Excuse me?
 - Could you repeat that, please?
 - I beg you pardon, but I don't quite understand.
- Which questions could Peter use to ask for clarification?
 - Has everyone got a copy of the agenda?
 - I'm sorry. Could you elaborate on that?
 - I'm not sure I know what you mean.
 - Excuse me, could you be more specific?
 - Do you mean this report?



Let's Practice!

Let's review the meeting!

Instructions: Read the clues on the left. Place a check mark in the correct box in the table. There is only one per clue.

	Opening the Meeting	Introducing the Agenda	Welcoming Participation	Closing the Meeting
Let's get down to business.				
Do you have any ideas Peter?				
The first thing in the Agenda is new potential client.				
Thank you for all your contributions and for attending today.				
I think this pretty much brings us				
I think that this pretty much brings us to the end of our meeting.				
Thank you all for making it on such short notice.				
Now I'd like us to turn to the next point on the Agenda.				





Extension Activity

I use phrases to keep the conversation going.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- You want to have a meeting with your co-workers about a new project.
- Think about what the project is. Jot down a few notes for the agenda for the meeting. What items do you want to talk about? Include 3 - 5 items.
- Review your agenda.
- Plan for your meeting:
 - How will you open the meeting?
 - How will you introduce the different items on your agenda?
 - How will you welcome participation?
 - How will you close the meeting?
- Write your answers down.
- Practice for your meeting aloud.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I talk about a project related to work.

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I write down items on an agenda.

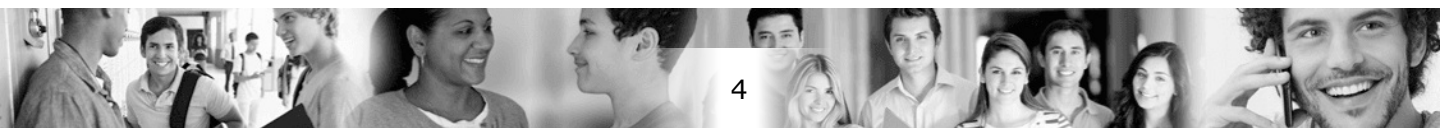
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I manage a meeting.

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Target Words

- **on short notice** (expression): quickly and not scheduled
e.g. Thank you for making it on short notice.
- **supporting documentation** (noun): written information used to summarize items discussed in a meeting
e.g. I have attached the supporting documentation to the report.
- **in advance** (expression): before something happens or is expected to happen
e.g. Did you read the report in advance?
- **on the lookout for** (expression): to pay attention in order to find something you want
e.g. They are on the lookout for a PR agency.
- **to express an interest** (expression): to say that you are interested in something
e.g. Our agency has expressed an interest in the deal.
- **to formalize** (verb): to make a plan official, by deciding and clearly describing all the details
e.g. We will have to formalize a proposal soon to send to them.
- **management** (noun): the activity of controlling and organizing the work that a company or organization does
e.g. What ideas do we have for their image management?
- **to stage** (verb): to organize a public event
e.g. We can use advertising to stage an event for the client.
- **to sponsor** (verb): to give money to an event in exchange for the right to advertise
e.g. We want to sponsor events so we can promote their clothing line.





Learning Points

Language for Managing Meetings

The language of meetings is central to business communication. Whether you are holding a meeting or attending one, it is important that you use and understand key language and expressions.

Opening a meeting properly, setting an agenda and time limits, keeping to the agenda, and closing a meeting are key components of an effective meeting. The chart below illustrates the most important language to help you hold or attend a meeting.

Opening the meeting • <i>I'd like to welcome everyone to the meeting.</i> • <i>Thank you all for making it at such short notice.</i> • <i>Shall we make a start?</i> • <i>Let's get down to business.</i> • <i>Has everyone got a copy of the agenda?</i> • <i>We're here to discuss ...</i> • <i>The objective of this meeting is to ...</i>	Introducing items on the agenda • <i>The first item on the agenda is ...</i> • <i>The first thing we need to look at is ...</i> • <i>The first thing we need to decide on is ...</i> • <i>Now I'd like us to turn to the next point on the agenda.</i>
Welcoming participation • <i>Do you have any ideas/suggestions ... ?</i> • <i>I'd like to hear your thoughts on this ...</i> • <i>What do you think about that ... ?</i>	Closing the meeting • <i>I think that this pretty much brings us to the end of our meeting.</i> • <i>So, I'd like to run briefly through all the points we've discussed.</i> • <i>Thank you all for your contribution to this meeting.</i> • <i>Thank you all for attending today.</i>





Learning Points

Dealing With Communication Breakdowns

Sometimes you don't understand what was said or something was not clear to you. It is, therefore, important to express your lack of understanding and seek clarification from the person you are talking to.

Expressing lacking of understanding	Asking for clarification
• <i>Sorry, I am not sure I am following you.</i> • <i>I beg your pardon, but I don't quite understand.</i> • <i>I'm not sure I know what you mean.</i> • <i>I'm not sure I follow you.</i>	• <i>Could you elaborate on that?</i> • <i>Could you be more specific?</i> • <i>Could you repeat that, please?</i> • <i>Could you clarify that, please?</i> • <i>Do you mean ... ?</i>

